# CHAPTER 1
# A Joyous Childhood

The ruler later known as Shah Jahan was the fifth emperor of the Mogul dynasty, which ruled much of what is present-day India from 1526 to 1858. At its height of power, the Mogul Empire included parts of Pakistan and Afghanistan.

The first six rulers of the Mogul Empire were probably the richest in the world at that time. European travelers spread the stories of the Moguls' fabulous wealth and power. The rulers of Europe admired the splendor and luxury of the Moguls. In the 1600s and 1700s the term "Great Mogul" meant the kind of powerful ruler that European monarchs wanted to be as well.